

THE SERAPHIM

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WHAT ARE ANGELS? OR MORE SPECIFICALLY, WHAT ARE THE SERAPHIM? We see angels from the beginning of the Bible to the very end. But what are they? Men with white clothes and wings? Floating balls of eyes? Dragons? And why are they described differently in different places? Why different names? Angels, Seraphim, Cherubim?

You might immediately write dragons off the list as an impossibility. After all, those are dinosaurs now and they're just animals. But that's not true at all. Dinosaurs are made up, and dragons are historically fact.

And there is a lot of evidence that points toward the Seraphim being what we used to know as dragons.

PRELIMINARY WORK

There are a couple things that people will use to object to the idea that angels might be dragons. The first is that dragons aren't real and they're dinosaurs. This can be easily discarded as an argument though.

Basically, this section exists to clear up any common arguments that don't actually apply or would cause someone to skip over this possibility.

ARE DRAGONS DINOSAURS?

Our knowledge of ancient skeletons—especially dinosaurs—is built on fragmentary and interpretive evidence, not complete certainty.

Most fossil skeletons are discovered incomplete, scattered, or distorted by geological pressure, erosion, and time. Paleontologists often recover only portions of a skeleton, sometimes a few bones, and must infer the rest by comparing them with related species. Missing elements are commonly mirrored, scaled, or substituted from better-known specimens, meaning that many "skeletons" represent a composite hypothesis rather than a single, fully known individual. Even bone orientation can be uncertain, as post-burial movement, sediment compaction, and tectonic activity can shift bones far from their original life position.

Additionally, reconstruction choices are shaped by prevailing scientific assumptions, which have changed significantly over time. Entire postures, limb positions, skull shapes, and proportions have been revised as new fossils or interpretations emerge.

This shows that skeletons are not neutral facts frozen in stone but models assembled through interpretation. While the bones themselves are real physical objects, the final skeletal mounts seen in museums often reflect the best current consensus, not absolute knowledge.

In the end, we are not sure of what we can our dinosaurs. What we do know is that ancient peoples described and drew creatures called dragons. While our "completed" skeletons might be wrong, incomplete, and sketchy, what we are sure of is the bones themselves. From just the head of the Tyrannosaurus Rex, we know that there was once a creature that it belonged to.

Historically, it makes more sense that these were dragons, not our modernized, sanitized, incomplete dinosaurs.

DRAGONS

Dragons are not myth. Although you may have been taught this, it is not remotely true. Many believe that dragons are myth and that where it is recorded in history, is just a false representation of something else.

GENERAL BODY STRUCTURE

Historical accounts consistently describe dragons as large reptilian creatures with either serpentine or lizard-like bodies. The torso is typically elongated, with notable regional variation: East Asian traditions emphasize a fully serpentine form, whereas European sources depict a more compact but massive body. Dragons are often described as growing larger with age, implying long lifespans and sustained physical development.

Their skin is universally described as covered in scales, frequently characterized as armor-like, metallic, or stone-like. These scales are commonly portrayed as resistant to conventional weapons, suggesting a natural defensive adaptation rather than supernatural invulnerability.

CRANIAL AND SENSORY FEATURES

Dragon heads are typically described as elongated or wedge-shaped, with powerful jaws containing sharp teeth or prominent fangs. Horns, crests, ridges, and spines are frequently noted, contributing to both defense and intimidation.

Many accounts describe additional facial features such as beards or whiskers, particularly in East Asian traditions. The eyes are consistently emphasized as prominent and expressive, often described as intelligent or piercing. In some sources, they are said to glow or to induce fear or paralysis through direct gaze, reinforcing the perception of dragons as highly aware predators.

LIMBS, WINGS, AND LOCOMOTION

Descriptions of dragon limbs vary across traditions. Dragons are most commonly depicted as having either two or four legs, terminating in strong, clawed extremities. Some accounts reference reduced or vestigial limbs, indicating variation within the broader category of dragon-like creatures.

Dragons are described as capable of diverse forms of movement, including walking, crawling, slithering, swimming, and flying. Wings are a defining feature in European and Middle Eastern traditions, where they are described as large, membranous, and bat-like. In contrast, most East Asian sources omit wings entirely while still attributing flight, suggesting that flight was not universally understood as dependent on wings.

BREATH, EMISSIONS, AND ENVIRONMENTAL EFFECTS

A defining trait in many traditions is the dragon's ability to emit destructive substances. These include fire, poisonous fumes, toxic breath, and superheated air or steam. Such emissions are often described not only as weapons but as environmental hazards.

Secondary effects attributed to dragon presence include poisoned water sources, withered vegetation, and air rendered dangerous or uninhabitable near dragon lairs. These descriptions imply a persistent ecological impact rather than isolated acts of destruction.

DEFENSIVE ADAPTATIONS AND VULNERABILITIES

Dragon scales are repeatedly described as capable of deflecting weapons, reinforcing the idea of natural armor. However, dragons are rarely portrayed as completely invulnerable. Many accounts identify specific weak points, most commonly the underbelly, throat, or eyes. The consistent inclusion of vulnerabilities contributes to a portrayal of dragons as biologically formidable rather than mythically invincible.

INTELLIGENCE AND BEHAVIORAL COMPLEXITY

Dragons are widely described as highly intelligent creatures. Historical sources emphasize their awareness of human activity, strategic behavior, and capacity for memory and planning. Rather than acting purely on instinct, dragons are often portrayed as responding deliberately to perceived threats or intrusions.

In some traditions, dragons are described as capable of limited communication, though this is typically indirect and non-verbal. Explicit speech is rare and generally confined to later literary or allegorical accounts.

SOCIAL AND BEHAVIORAL PATTERNS

Across cultures, dragons are almost uniformly portrayed as solitary and territorial. They are frequently described as ancient beings, sometimes already considered old or rare within early historical records. Dragons are commonly associated with lairs, often located in remote or difficult-to-access environments.

DIET AND PREDATORY ROLE

Dragons are typically depicted as apex predators. Their diet commonly includes livestock and wild animals, and in some traditions, humans. These depictions emphasize the perceived threat dragons posed to human communities, particularly in agrarian societies.

HABITAT AND ENVIRONMENTAL DISTRIBUTION

Dragon habitats are consistently described as remote or extreme environments. These include mountains and caves, swamps and wetlands, rivers and lakes, ruins and abandoned structures, and volcanic or geothermally active regions. Aquatic habitats are especially prominent in East Asian, Middle Eastern, and some European traditions, indicating that water-associated dragons were a widespread concept.

COMMUNICATION AND COGNITIVE INTERACTION

Historical sources rarely attribute verbal speech to dragons, but when speech is described, it is treated as deliberate, limited, and purposeful rather than conversational. Dragons that speak do so briefly, often issuing warnings, declarations, or riddling statements. Such speech is typically associated with exceptionally old or powerful dragons and appears more frequently in later literary or philosophical traditions, suggesting that verbal language was considered an advanced or uncommon capability rather than a defining trait.

Some traditions describe dragons as capable of non-verbal mental influence, often interpreted as telepathic or telekinetic in nature. Humans are said to sense a dragon's presence, intent, or hostility prior to any physical encounter. Effects such as sudden fear, paralysis, or compelled retreat are attributed not to direct physical action, but to an imposed mental or psychological force. In certain accounts, dragons appear to influence movement, weather, or surrounding matter without observable physical contact, reinforcing the perception of cognitive power extending beyond the body.

Alongside these higher-order forms of communication, dragons consistently employ behavioral and environmental signaling. Roars, hisses, posture displays, breath emissions, and deliberate environmental disturbances function as clear warnings or assertions of dominance. These layered modes of communication—verbal, mental, and environmental—collectively portray dragons as highly intelligent entities capable of conveying intent through multiple channels rather than relying on instinctive behavior alone.

OVERVIEW

Taken together, historical descriptions^{B1} present dragons as large, intelligent, reptilian beings with advanced defensive adaptations, diverse locomotion, and significant environmental impact. The consistency of these descriptions across geographically and culturally distinct societies suggests that dragons were conceived not merely as symbolic constructs, but as concrete entities within early explanatory frameworks of the natural world.

ANGELS DESCRIBED IN THE BIBLE

It is important to note that "angel" is a role, not a race or type of creature that God created. Inside this broad term "angel" exist at least three groups: Seraphim, Cherubim, and Human-like messengers.

The Bible describes angels many different ways in the Bible. In some places, it describes human-like beings, in another place it might be describing a creature with many faces.

Many at this point may be wondering how the Bible actually describes angels. And does it lines up with the dragon imagery. Yes and no. Let's break it up. Here is every place in the Bible that describes angels:

Human-Form Messengers (Angels Appearing as Men)

And he lift up his eyes and looked, and, lo, **three men stood by him**: and when he saw them, he ran to meet them from the tent door, and bowed himself toward the ground.

Genesis 18:2

And there came two angels to Sodom at even; and Lot sat in the gate of Sodom: and Lot seeing them rose up to meet them; and he bowed himself with his face toward the ground.

Genesis 19:1

And they called unto Lot, and said unto him, **Where are the men which came in to thee this night?** bring them out unto us, that we may know them.

Genesis 19:5

Then the woman came and told her husband, saying, **A man of God came unto me, and his countenance was like the countenance of an angel of God, very terrible.**

Judges 13:6

Yea, whiles I was speaking in prayer, even **the man Gabriel**, whom I had seen in the vision at the beginning, being caused to fly swiftly, touched me about the time of the evening oblation.

Daniel 9:21

Then I lifted up mine eyes, and looked, and **behold a certain man clothed in linen**, whose loins were girded with fine gold of Uphaz: His body also was like the beryl, and **his face as the appearance of lightning**, and his eyes as lamps of fire, and **his arms and his feet like in colour to polished brass**, and the voice of his words like **the voice of a multitude.**

Daniel 10:5–6

And it came to pass, as they were much perplexed thereabout, behold, **two men stood by them in shining garments.**

Luke 24:4

And while they looked stedfastly toward heaven as he went up, behold, **two men stood by them in white apparel.**

Acts 1:10

Seraphim (Fiery Flying Serpents)

Above it stood the seraphims: each one had six wings; with twain he covered his face, and with twain he covered his feet, and with twain he did fly. And one cried unto another, and said, Holy, holy, holy, is the LORD of hosts: the whole earth is full of his glory.

Isaiah 6:2–3

Then flew one of the seraphims unto me, having a live coal in his hand, which he had taken with the tongs from off the altar.

Isaiah 6:6

Cherubim/Living Creatures (Composite, Multi-Faced Beings)

And I looked, and, behold, a whirlwind came out of the north, a great cloud, and a fire infolding itself, and a brightness was about it, and out of the midst thereof as the colour of amber, out of the midst of the fire. Also **out of the midst thereof came the likeness of four living creatures.** And this was their appearance; **they had the likeness of a man. And every one had four faces, and every one had four wings.**

Ezekiel 1:4–6

As for the likeness of their faces, they four had the face of a man, and the face of a lion, on the right side: and they four had the face of an ox on the left side; they four also had the face of an eagle. And their wings were stretched upward; two wings of every one were joined one to another, and two covered their bodies.

Ezekiel 1:10–11

And their appearance was like burning coals of fire, and like the appearance of lamps: it went up and down among the living creatures; and the fire was bright, and out of the fire went forth lightning.

Ezekiel 1:13

This is the living creature that I saw under the God of Israel by the river of Chebar; and I knew that they were the cherubims. Every one had four faces apiece, and every one four wings; and the likeness of the hands of a man was under their wings.

Ezekiel 10:20–21

And the four beasts had each of them six wings about him; and they were full of eyes within: and they rest not day and night, saying, Holy, holy, holy, Lord God Almighty, which was, and is, and is to come.

Revelation 4:8

If you mash all of this into one description, you get a really bizarre shape-shifting lizard fire man. Because at times people see them as mere men, or terrifying monsters. It makes way more sense if angels are the messengers of God (in human-like form), the Cherubim guard the throne of God, and the Seraphim are the workers of judgment, destruction, and suffering.

Angel means "messenger," so obviously the Cherubim (who only guard God's throne) are not messengers of God. They aren't angels. And the same goes for the Seraphim. They are never called angels, and are never seen being a messenger. Unless you count bringing judgment and destruction as being a messenger. But that's more like a warrior being, not angelic messenger.

Whatever the Bible is describing is really hard to visualize if you try to think of them all as the same creature. But broken into the three categories, it makes a lot more sense. Human-like messengers are the angels that appear in human form. Cherubim (meaning throne guardians or attendants of divine presence) are the ones who guard the throne of God. And Seraphim are the fiery flying serpents that inflict suffering and judgment on man.

So, to be clear, this paper is arguing that the Seraphim might be dragons. Not that all angels or the Cherubim or anything else are dragons. Just the Seraphim. They're the one's that fit the description.

SERAPHIM

Everyone knows about Seraphim and Cherubim, any a lot of those are aware that these are different kinds or ranks of angelic beings. What they likely do not know, is that *seraphim* means: fiery flying serpent.

You might be quick to double check my work, and if you look it up you won't see it defined as such. So let me explain.

The Hebrew term behind *seraph* and *seraphim* comes from the root *śāraph*, which simply means "to burn." On its own, the word does not identify a specific type of being. Biblical Hebrew assigns meaning primarily through context, not through narrowly defined vocabulary. As a result, *śāraph* can describe anything characterized by burning (fire, judgment, pain, or a "burning one.") This is why the same root can be applied to different manifestations without changing the word itself.

And the LORD sent fiery serpents among the people, and they bit the people; and much people of Israel died.

Numbers 21:6

Out of the serpent's root shall come forth a cockatrice, and his fruit shall be a fiery flying serpent.

Isaiah 14:29

The burden of the beasts of the south: into the land of trouble and anguish, from whence come the young and old lion, the viper, and fiery flying serpent, and they will carry their riches upon the shoulders of young asses, and their treasures upon the bunches of camels, to a people that shall not profit them.

Isaiah 30:6

In the passages above, the burning effect is associated with venom and judgment in the wilderness, and the context clearly identifies the subject as a serpent. When additional descriptive language is included, such as movement or wings, the KJV renders this as a "fiery flying serpent."

In contrast, in Isaiah 6 the same root appears in a heavenly throne-room setting, describing the Seraphim as radiant, winged beings associated with fire and holiness.

In the year that king Uzziah died I saw also the Lord sitting upon a throne, high and lifted up, and his train filled the temple. Above it stood the seraphims: each one had six wings; with twain he covered his face, and with twain he covered his feet, and with twain he did fly. And one cried unto another, and said, Holy, holy, holy, is the LORD of hosts: the whole earth is full of his glory. And the posts of the door moved at the voice of him that cried, and the house was filled with smoke. Then said I, Woe is me! for I am undone; because I am a man of unclean lips, and I dwell in the midst of a people of unclean lips: for mine eyes have seen the King, the LORD of hosts. Then flew one of the seraphims unto me, having a live coal in his hand, which he had taken with the tongs from off the altar: And he laid it upon my mouth, and said, Lo, this hath touched thy lips; and thine iniquity is taken away, and thy sin purged.

Isaiah 6:1-7

The meaning shifts not because the word changes, but because the setting, function, and descriptors change, making "fiery flying serpent" a legitimate contextual meaning of the same Hebrew root.

So *seraphim* in the sense of one of God's angels, best means "fiery flying serpent."

WHAT IS A FIERY FLYING SERPENTS

What is a fiery flying serpent? If you try and compare those three terms to any creature ever seen in history or ever recorded. You will find it best aligns the Seraphim with the dragons of old.

While the word *seraphim* is never directly connected to dragons (unless you count the Leviathan or Satan), it describes the exact attributes that are said to belong to dragons. It could just be a mythical creature of God. But if we try and match it to something seen in the past, we find dragons.

SEREF

Seref (sʾrf) is Egyptian, and is basically their term for *śāraph*. While there no proven connection between the words, each words sound, meaning, and imagery have lead some to argue that the Hebrews took the Egyptian word *seref* and that's were *śāraph* comes from. Others counter this by claiming the Egyptians got *seref* from the Hebrews. But it doesn't matter for the sake of this argument who got the word from who.

Seref refers to a burning or dangerous serpent in ancient Egyptian usage. The word is associated with fire, heat, and venom. The idea of something that burns or scorches.

In texts and later scholarly reconstructions, a *seref* is not a neutral animal but a supernatural or divinely empowered serpent, one whose bite, breath, or presence is destructive. The emphasis is on the burning effect rather than on zoological detail.

Conceptually, *seref* functions as a serpent of judgment or protection, and matches the known Egyptian seal(shown to the right).

It can represent a threat unleashed by divine power or a guardian force that destroys enemies. This is why scholars often note its similarity to the Hebrew *śāraph*.



Seals matching the imagery for the word *seref*

CROOKED LEVIATHAN

Many people only know of Leviathan from the book of Job. But it's actually all over the Old Testament:

Let them curse it that curse the day, who are ready to raise up leviathan.

Job 3:8

Canst thou draw out leviathan with an hook? or his tongue with a cord which thou lettest down?

Job 41:1

Thou brakest the heads of leviathan in pieces, and gavest him to be meat to the people inhabiting the wilderness.

Psalms 74:14

There go the ships: there is that leviathan, whom thou hast made to play therein.

Psalms 104:26

In that day the LORD with his sore and great and strong sword shall punish leviathan the piercing serpent, even leviathan that crooked serpent; and he shall slay the dragon that is in the sea.

Isaiah 27:1

All these verses frame the Leviathan as a powerful, feared, creature of the sea. But the last verse, Isaiah 27:1, mentions that in the day of the Lord, God will slay the Leviathan. But the creature isn't called just the Leviathan. The Bible calls the Leviathan a crooked serpent, and the dragon of the sea.

Apart from the names it is called here, why would God be focused on a sea serpent at the end of the world? What did this serpent do? And why is it such a big deal?

It makes a lot more sense if the Leviathan is a fallen angel of God. Because now that verse would be saying that at the end of time, that fallen angel, that crooked serpent, the dragon that is in the sea, will be slain and made an end of.

THAT GREAT DRAGON SATAN

Satan is called a dragon. This isn't connecting the dots, it isn't trying to infer something not there. This is a literal reading of the verses below (which could be argued against, seeing as it is Revelation).

And there appeared another wonder in heaven; and behold a great red dragon, having seven heads and ten horns, and seven crowns upon his heads.

Revelation 12:3

And the great dragon was cast out, that old serpent, called the Devil, and Satan, which deceiveth the whole world: he was cast out into the earth, and his angels were cast out with him.

Revelation 12:9

And when the dragon saw that he was cast unto the earth, he persecuted the woman which brought forth the man child.

Revelation 12:13

And he laid hold on the dragon, that old serpent, which is the Devil, and Satan, and bound him a thousand years.

Revelation 20:2

Could these be poetic, or figurative? Yes. But, pair this with Leviathan and it starts making more sense if it does actually mean that Satan is a dragon. It's not that this is the one way to read the Bible, or that this is the only way that makes sense. It's that this way makes the most sense.

This passage clearly connects Satan to being a dragon. And this begs the question, if Satan is not a dragon, why the connection? The mainstream answer you would find to this question is: the connection

exists because the Bible uses dragon imagery to describe Satan's role and nature, not because Satan is biologically a dragon.

Does this explain it? Yeah. Is this all there is here? Probably not.

WORLD WIDE

A pretty strong argument can be made just because of the fact that human-like angels are not seen all over the world. And if the Bible is true, and God works world-wide, we would expect to see his beings everywhere. If all angels are human-like, then we have an issue. But if a large portion of them are also dragons, then we have something.

We see dragons absolutely everywhere. They span every culture, all over the world. Nowadays people explain this by saying that they just were seeing dinosaurs. But these ancient people claimed that these were supernatural beings. This in itself is insane and points toward these being more than just creatures. If ancient man didn't think that these creatures were mere animals, but attributed supernatural causes to them, why do we write them off as dinosaurs?

CONCLUSION

The idea that biblical angels are actually dragons fits extremely well. One could ask the question, if the Bible is true, why don't we see angels across the world? And the answer might be that we've been looking for them in the wrong way. They are not the winged glowing men that we thought they were, they might be dragons of old. Those feared beasts. And those indeed are world-wide.

SOURCES

Video sources in this paper are available for download from my ProtonDrive at:

* Indicates a topic or source that was uncovered with the help of an AI model (ChatGPT, Grok, etc.). The facts and sources themselves are independently studied and verified by the author. No AI model is taken at it's word.

Email TheOregonTrail@protonmail.com if you would like to ask a question, found an error throughout this paper, or have more evidence you would like to present to me (regarding either side of the debate).

PRELIMINARY WORK

[B1] Herodotus, Histories (winged serpents, sound and fear signaling):

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<https://www.sacred-texts.com/ane/eog/eog05.htm>; Dragon roars and territorial signaling: *Beowulf*, trans. Seamus Heaney, W. W. Norton & Company, 2000; Dragons as omens and movement symbols: *Historia Regum Britanniae*, Book VII; Feathered serpent omens and signs:

<https://www.mexicolore.co.uk/aztecs/gods/quetzalcoatl>; Large serpents signaling danger:

The Travels of Marco Polo, Book II, Chapter XLIX; Classical dragon behavior and signaling:

Daniel Ogden, *Drakōn: Dragon Myth and Serpent Cult*, Oxford University Press, 2013; Mythic non-verbal communication patterns: Claude Lévi-Strauss, *Myth and Meaning*, University of Toronto Press

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Revelation 20:2